

# Word family: \*\*reputation / reputations / reputable / reputably / disreputable\*\*

\*\*Base word:\*\* reputation

\*\*Plural:\*\* reputations

\*\*Related forms:\*\* reputable, reputably, disreputable

\*\*Part of speech:\*\* noun ( 名詞 ) / related adjective and adverb forms ( 相關形容詞及副詞 )

Your sentence:

> “It has a serious \*\*reputation\*\*, and I had the impression that I would need to be fully focused to appreciate it properly.”

## Meaning in this passage

Here, \*\*reputation\*\* means the \*\*general opinion or image that people have of a person, organization, product, book, place, etc., based on what is widely believed or known about it\*\*.

In your sentence, the book has a reputation for being \*\*serious, intellectually demanding, and substantial\*\*.

\*\*繁體中文\*\*： \*\*名聲；聲譽；大眾對某人或某事物長期形成的整體看法\*\*

\*\*中文翻譯\*\*：

> “It has a serious \*\*reputation\*\*...”

「它有一種很嚴肅的\*\*名聲 / 聲譽\*\*.....」

Here:

\*\*reputation = 人們普遍怎樣看待這本書，以及它在人們心目中建立起來的形象\*\*

---

# 1. \*\*reputation = general opinion people have of someone/something ( 名聲 / 聲譽 ) — 名聲；聲譽\*\*

This is the core meaning used in your passage.

\*\*Meaning:\*\* The overall opinion that people have formed about a person, organization, place, product, work, etc.

### Practice 1 — Original

> “The book has a serious \*\*reputation\*\*.”

「這本書有一種很嚴肅的\*\*名聲 / 形象\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 2

> “The restaurant has an excellent \*\*reputation\*\*.”

「這間餐廳有很好的\*\*聲譽\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 3

> “The company has built a strong \*\*reputation\*\* for quality.”

「這家公司建立了重視品質的良好\*\*聲譽\*\*。」

**\*\*reputation = 其他人根據長期印象、經驗或傳聞，對某人 / 某事形成的整體評價\*\***

Common:

- \* good reputation
- \* bad reputation
- \* strong reputation
- \* excellent reputation
- \* reputation for something

---

# 2. **\*\*reputation = a particular known characteristic ( 以某種特點聞名 ) — 名聲 ; 形象\*\***

**\*\*Reputation\*\*** often appears in the pattern:

> **\*\*have a reputation for + noun / -ing\*\***

meaning that someone or something is widely known for a particular quality or behaviour.

#### ### Practice 4

> “He has a \*\*reputation for\*\* being difficult to work with.”

「他有\*\*難以合作的名聲\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 5

> “The school has a \*\*reputation for\*\* academic excellence.”

「這間學校以學術表現優秀而\*\*聞名\*\*。」

**\*\*have a reputation for something = 因某種特點、行為或表現而廣為人知\*\***

For strict counting, this is not a separate meaning from #1. It is an important construction within the same core concept.

---

# 3. **\*\*reputation = public standing/prestige ( 社會地位 ) — 聲望 ; 名望\*\***

In some contexts, **\*\*reputation\*\*** emphasizes the degree of respect or prestige someone has.

### Practice 6

> “She has a considerable **\*\*reputation\*\*** in the academic world.”

「她在學術界有相當高的**\*\*聲望\*\***。」

### Practice 7

> “His international **\*\*reputation\*\*** continued to grow.”

「他的國際**\*\*聲望\*\***持續提升。」

**\*\*reputation = 某人在某領域中累積的名望、可信度或受尊重程度\*\***

This is closely related to Meaning 1, but with stronger emphasis on **\*\*standing/prestige\*\***.

For core counting, I would merge it with #1.

---

# 4. **\*\*reputation = known image, whether accurate or not ( 形象 ) — 名聲 ; 既定印象\*\***

A reputation does not necessarily mean the opinion is objectively correct.

### Practice 8

> “The city has a **\*\*reputation\*\*** for being expensive.”

「這座城市有『生活成本很高』的**\*\*名聲 / 印象\*\***。」

### Practice 9

> “He has an unfair **\*\*reputation\*\*** for being unfriendly.”

「他被人認為不友善，但這種**\*\*名聲\*\***其實不公平。」

**\*\*reputation = 人們普遍形成的既定印象，未必完全符合事實\*\***

Again, this belongs to the same central meaning.

---

# Related form: **\*\*reputable\*\***

**\*\*Reputable\*\*** means generally respected and trusted because of a good reputation.

### Practice 10

> “Always buy from a **\*\*reputable\*\*** seller.”

「一定要向**\*\*信譽良好的\*\***賣家購買。」

### Practice 11

> “The article was published by a **\*\*reputable\*\*** journal.”

「這篇文章刊登在一家**\*\*聲譽良好的\*\***期刊上。」

**\*\*reputable = 因良好聲譽而值得信任、受到尊重的\*\***

Common:

\* reputable company

\* reputable source

\* reputable university

\* reputable dealer

---

# Related form: **\*\*reputably\*\***

**\*\*Reputably\*\*** means according to reputation or in a way associated with a good reputation.

This form is valid but relatively uncommon.

### Practice 12

> “The firm is **\*\*reputably\*\*** well managed.”

「據其聲譽來看，這家公司管理得相當好。」

For learner priority, **reputable** is much more useful than **reputably**.

---

# Related form: **disreputable**

**Disreputable** means having a bad reputation or not being considered respectable/trustworthy.

### Practice 13

> “The area was once known for its **disreputable** bars.”

「那個地區曾因一些**聲名狼藉的**酒吧而出名。」

### Practice 14

> “He dealt with a **disreputable** company.”

「他和一家**信譽不佳的**公司有來往。」

**disreputable** = 名聲差、不體面、不值得信任的

---

# Important distinction: **reputation** vs **fame**

### **fame**

= being widely known

### **reputation**

= what people think of you or know you for

A person can be famous but have a bad reputation.

So:

> fame = 名氣

> reputation = 名聲 / 聲譽

---

# Important distinction: **reputation** vs **image**

### **image**

often means the impression presented to the public, sometimes deliberately created.

### \*\*reputation\*\*

usually develops over time from what people believe, experience, or hear.

> company image

> company reputation

A company may try to create a certain image, but its reputation depends more on how others actually perceive it.

---

# Important distinction: \*\*reputation vs prestige\*\*

### \*\*prestige\*\*

means high status and respect.

### \*\*reputation\*\*

can be:

\* good

\* bad

\* mixed

\* neutral

So \*\*prestige\*\* is inherently positive, while \*\*reputation\*\* is neutral by itself.

---

# Important distinction: \*\*reputation vs status\*\*

### \*\*status\*\*

means position or rank within a group or society.

### \*\*reputation\*\*

means what others think about someone/something.

A person can have high status but a poor reputation.

---

# Important distinction: **reputation vs credibility**

### **credibility**

means being believable or trustworthy.

### **reputation**

is broader and can concern:

- \* quality
- \* behaviour
- \* prestige
- \* reliability
- \* difficulty
- \* seriousness

For example:

> “The book has a serious reputation.”

This is not about whether the book is believable; it is about how people generally perceive it.

---

# Grammar note: **reputation for / reputation as**

Two patterns are especially important.

## **a reputation for + quality/action**

> “She has a reputation for honesty.”

「她以誠實著稱。」

## **a reputation as + role/type**

> “He has a reputation as a skilled negotiator.”

「他以出色談判者的身分享有名聲。」

So:

\* **for** → quality/behaviour

\* \*\*as\*\* → identity/role

---

## # Countability note

**Reputation** can be both countable and uncountable-ish depending on context.

### ### Singular/general

> “The company has a good reputation.”

### ### Plural

> “The two branches developed very different reputations.”

Plural is possible when referring to distinct reputations held by different people/groups or attached to different entities.

But in ordinary usage, singular **a reputation** is much more common.

---

# Useful construction: **build/earn a reputation** — 建立名聲

### ### Practice 15

> “The author built a reputation for careful research.”

「這位作者憑仔細研究建立了自己的**聲譽**。」

### ### Practice 16

> “She earned a reputation as a fair manager.”

「她贏得了公平管理者的**名聲**。」

---

# Useful construction: **live up to one's reputation** — 不負盛名 / 名副其實

This appears later in your passage:

> “if it lives up to its reputation...”

### ### Practice 17

> “The restaurant really lived up to its **reputation**.”

「這間餐廳真的**不負盛名 / 名副其實**。」

### ### Practice 18

> “The film did not live up to its **reputation**.”

「這部電影沒有**達到其名聲所帶來的期待**。」

**live up to one's reputation** = 表現真的符合別人一直以來對它的高度評價或既定印象

This is a very useful fixed expression from your exact passage.

---

### # Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

\* **reputation**

\* **reputations**

\* **reputable**

\* **disreputable**

**Reputably** exists but is low priority.

Most uses of **reputation** share one central semantic concept:

> **the opinion or public image that develops around a person or thing**

Differences such as **good reputation**, **academic reputation**, **reputation for being strict**, **international reputation** are mainly collocational and should not be split into artificial meanings.

### # Master comparison

| Form / sense | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |
|--------------|---------------------------------------|
|--------------|---------------------------------------|

|       |       |
|-------|-------|
| ----- | ----- |
|-------|-------|

|                                     |                               |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| <b>reputation</b> — general opinion | 大眾或某群體長期對某人 / 某事形成的整體看法、名聲或聲譽 |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------|

|                                 |                     |
|---------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>reputation for something</b> | 因某種特點、行為或表現而廣為人知的名聲 |
|---------------------------------|---------------------|

|                                       |                                         |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>reputation</b> — prestige/standing | 在某領域累積的名望或受尊重程度；屬於 general reputation 義 |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|

|                  |                  |
|------------------|------------------|
| <b>reputable</b> | 因良好聲譽而值得信任、受到尊重的 |
|------------------|------------------|

|                     |                |
|---------------------|----------------|
| <b>disreputable</b> | 名聲差、不體面或不值得信任的 |
|---------------------|----------------|

| **\*\*live up to a reputation\*\*** | 表現符合既有名聲和由此產生的期待 |

# For your original sentence

> “It has a serious **\*\*reputation\*\***...”

The exact meaning is:

**\*\*reputation = 人們普遍認為這本書嚴肅、厚重、需要專注閱讀的既定形象\*\***

So:

> **\*\*a serious reputation\*\***

= **\*\*一種「這是一本嚴肅、需要認真讀的書」的名聲 / 形象\*\***

And later:

> “if it lives up to its reputation...”

means:

**\*\*如果它真的達到人們一直賦予它的高度評價 / 既定名聲所帶來的期待\*\***

For your database, **\*\*reputation is semantically quite unified\*\***. I would count **\*\*1 main core meaning\*\***:

1. **\*\*the general opinion, image, or standing that people have formed about someone or something\*\***

I would treat **\*\*reputation for\*\***, **\*\*reputation as\*\***, **\*\*good/bad reputation\*\***, and **\*\*prestige-like uses\*\*** as constructions or contextual extensions of that same core meaning, rather than artificially splitting them. **\*\*Reputable / disreputable\*\*** should remain family extensions.